

Deer velvet in S. Korea (2nd quarter of 2024)

Reported on 10th of July 2024

1 Quarantine statistics of deer velvet from major export countries¹⁸

1.1 Dried velvet

Dried velvet (kg)								
Country	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024 (~Jun)
New Zealand	61,815	78,410	44,535	37,811	24,369	39,655	47,958	10,896
China	61,972	74,117	69,716	77,990	72,634	89,569	74,318	49,137
Russia	50,989	42,132	46,450	54,042	55,986	43,896	29,109	23,932
Hong Kong	11,293	15,402	17,828	13,701	22,372	23,835	12,597	87
Kazakhstan	1,081	1,270	701	2,354	1,428	2,097	1,095	
Total	187,198	211,410	179,782	185,931	176,842	199,086	165,095	84,058

1.2 Frozen velvet

Frozen velvet (kg)								
Country	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024 (~Jun)
New Zealand	64,809	81,365	99,113	77,477	91,874	116,584	116,292	55,340
China	68	6	10		2		2.6	418.5
Russia		3						
Total	64,900	81,380	99,124	77,477	91,877	116,591	116,295	55,759

1.3 Rolling year

Dried velvet (kg)			Frozen velvet (kg)		
Country	July 2022	July 2023	Country	July 2022 -	July 2023 -
	-	-		June 2023	June 2024
New Zealand	43,946	29,476	New Zealand	125,867	85,502
China	95,042	88,461	China	0.2	420.9*

Russia	48,474	45,936	Russia		
Hong Kong	12,471	4,463	Hong Kong		
Kazakhstan	1,925	911	Kazakhstan		
Australia	24	14	Australia	0.1	0.2
USA	2.9	0.9	USA		
Others	0.1	0.2	Others	4.7	0.4
Total	201,885	169,260	Total	125,872	85,924

*400 kg frozen velvet from China cleared Korea customs in February of 2024.

2 Korean news

2.1 Korean deer velvet is NZD 483 per kg (KRW 386,700)

According to a recent report from a farm, the trading price of **Korean deer velvet** harvested in 2023 is approximately KRW 14,500 per 37.5g (1 Nyang). [It is about **483 NZD per kg**] This is a slight increase from mid-February, when the price was KRW 13,000. It is believed that the price has risen because the farm's stock of deer velvet is nearly depleted.



2024-03-25, The Korea Deer Times

2.2 Controversy over deer abuse: proposal to make deer velvet cutting private

PETA filed complaints in November 2023 with South Korean authorities, alleging animal abuse during deer velvet cutting on farms and shared videos with media. In response, at a Korean Deer Association’s annual event on April 3 with 150 attendees, suggestions were made **to restrict consumer access and filming at antler cutting sites, establish separate cutting facilities, and fully anesthetize deer before cutting**. Veterinarian Yu Il-jun noted that while most farms focus on animal welfare, some still face issues like cramped spaces and unsanitary conditions that need improvement.



2024-04-10, The Korea Deer Times

2.3 Deer placenta products gain popularity

Recently, products made from deer placenta have become popular. In South Korea, the cumulative sales of deer placenta ampoule "DPL Care 365" have reached 30 million bottles. This trend is driven by the similarity of deer placenta amino acid structures to those of humans. A study found that placenta extract is effective for liver disease fibrosis, inducing liver regeneration, and controlling inflammatory responses. However, a drawback is that only New Zealand deer placenta is certified by the Ministry of Food and Drug Safety. Lee Hae-gon,

president of the Korea Deer Farmers Association, emphasized the need for research on domestic deer products.



2024-04-10, The Korea Deer Times

2.4 Innes Moffat resigns as CEO of DINZ

Innes Moffat, who led DINZ for the past 20 years, is known for providing a clear vision for the New Zealand deer industry, building practical solutions, and demonstrating excellent work skills. The March issue of New Zealand Deer Industry News features a biography and tribute to his accomplishments. He had a strong connection with South Korea, meeting Korea Deer Farmers Association President Jeong Hwan-dae during his visit to New Zealand in 2020 and meeting in South Korea in 2022.

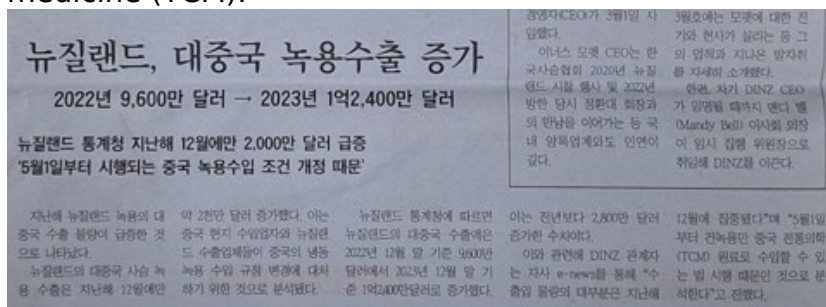


2024-04-10, The Korea Deer Times

2.5 Surge in New Zealand deer velvet exports to China last year

Last year saw a significant **increase in New Zealand's deer velvet exports to China**. In December alone, New Zealand's deer velvet exports to China rose by approximately \$20 million. This surge is attributed to New Zealand exporters and Chinese importers adapting to changes in China's frozen deer velvet import regulations.

According to Statistics New Zealand, the export value to China increased from \$96 million at the end of December 2022 to \$124 million at the end of December 2023, marking a \$28 million increase year-on-year. A DINZ representative stated in their e-newsletter that most of the export volume was concentrated in December, likely due to the implementation of a law effective May 1 that allows only dried deer antler to be imported as a raw material for traditional Chinese medicine (TCM).



2024-04-10, The Korea Deer Times

2.6 Seoul Association of Korean Medicine to host K-MEX

The Seoul Association of Korean Medicine will hold the first International Korean Medicine and Integrative Medicine Industry Expo (K-MEX) on June 23 at COEX Hall C in Seoul.

The association was selected to organize and operate the event after forming a consortium with Mediround Inc. and receiving a grant of 200 million won from the Seoul Metropolitan Government.

K-MEX will feature various events, including overseas buyer consultations, Korean medicine wellness tours, networking for industry professionals, and seminars to attract foreign patients. **The event aims to boost medical tourism and is expected to draw over 80 companies and 10,000 visitors.**

It will run alongside mandatory continuing education for association members, offering a dual benefit of education and industry insight.

There are comprehensive efforts to enhance the recognition of Korean medicine globally and the anticipated growth of the industry through this expo.

2024-04-19, AKOM News¹

2.7 Nonghyup Safe Deer Velvet

The perception that New Zealand velvet antler is superior to South Korean velvet antler is incorrect. Kim Yong-an, who has been researching velvet antler at the Korean Deer & Rabbit Cooperative since 2018, explains that claims of inferior quality are rumours spread by importers. The Nonghyup Safe Velvet Antler brand, established in 2020, ensures safe consumption through an 8-stage quality management system. Kim emphasizes efforts to support members and produce high-quality, safe velvet antler products for consumers.

2024-04-24, AFL (agriculture, fisheries & livestock) News²

2.8 BioDot: Connecting faith and business

Interview. BioDot, a 40-year-old traditional Korean medicine company, deals with natural products like deer velvet and agarwood.

CEO Han Hyun-jin joined in 2006 to support his struggling father's business.

Through efficiency improvements and diversification, he transformed the company's trajectory. The company has established the only integrated deer velvet processing facility in Korea and engages in direct trade with producers in New Zealand and Russia. And then supplies raw materials to over 500 businesses and clinics, including major companies like KGC Ginseng Corporation and Pulmuone.

In 2021, BioDot rebranded as a 'Mission Company,' aiming to integrate faith and business. Their vision is to be a 'bio industry platform.' They supply raw materials to over 500 companies and clinics, emphasizing quality and innovation.

BioDot has launched a brand called HanDong Deer Velvet Research and operates an experience center at its headquarters. They've expanded into cosmetics and pet food through subsidiaries, emphasizing natural ingredient supply.

¹ https://www.ekomnews.com/bbs/board.php?bo_table=news&wr_id=57568

² <https://www.aflnews.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=270048>



2024-04-27, Kukmin Ilbo³

2.9 Junggwanjang launches a specialized brand line-up with agarwood

Junggwanjang launches "Kidarim (longed-for) Agarwood," a specialized **brand marking its entry into the agarwood market**. Agarwood, known for its healing resin secreted by wounded trees, is highly valued worldwide. The brand ensures quality by using genetic analysis and Indonesian government certification. It offers two product lines: pure agarwood extract and agarwood pills blended with various herbs. Kim Eun-sung, a senior manager, emphasizes their commitment to providing only high-quality agarwood products.



2024-04-30, Fortune Korea⁴

2.10 Lim Young-woong's Junggwanjang ad hit 10 million views in just 10 days

A Korean trot music singer [Lim Young-woong](#)'s **Junggwanjang advertisement video surpassed 10 million views in just 10 days** after its release. It was part of the "Healthy and Happy, Junggwanjang" promotion launched on April 24th at 8 a.m. via Junggwanjang's official YouTube channel, "Junggwanjang TV".

In the video, Lim Young-woong showcases his daily routine, from morning rituals to singing practice, all while incorporating Junggwanjang products. Two episodes of the "Healthy and Happy" series gained attention, particularly among female viewers aged 55 to 64 and male viewers aged 35 to 44.

The video attracted over 6,000 comments, expressing support and encouragement for Lim Young-woong and Junggwanjang products. Lim's popularity also boosted Junggwanjang's "Family Month" promotion, with 20,000 new members joining and increased sales of popular products like "Hong Sam Jeong" and "Cheon Nok."

KGC Ginseng Corporation will continue the "Healthy and Happy, Junggwanjang" promotion until May 17th, offering benefits to customers purchasing products at Junggwanjang stores or online malls.

³ <https://www.kmib.co.kr/article/view.asp?arcid=1713857828>

⁴ <https://www.fortunekorea.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=37690>



2024-05-06, Food Today⁵

2.11 HY's fermented deer velvet shows promising antioxidant and recovery effects

hy published a study on the anti-fatigue and antioxidant effects of its proprietary fermented deer velvet in the "International Journal of Molecular Sciences." The fermented deer velvet, developed by fermenting deer velvet with the probiotic strain HY7602, showed significant reduction in oxidative stress and cell damage in muscle cells. In liver cells, it activated antioxidant enzymes, increased related gene expression, and reduced inflammation-related gene expression, indicating potential fatigue relief. Tests on middle-aged animals consuming the fermented deer velvet for four weeks showed improved exercise performance and reduced fatigue indicators like blood lactate, LDH, and CK. hy has applied for a patent on antioxidant and liver function benefits. hy emphasized ongoing research to enhance the functional properties of fermented deer velvet and other materials using their probiotics and natural products library.



2024-05-13, Food News⁶

2.12 Warmer weather, lower yield

Concerns over the **impact of warmer daytime temperatures on the yield and quality of deer velvet antler harvesting.** This year, in Korean deer farms, there have been occurrences of shorter growing periods and reduced weight of antlers. According to one veterinarian, "The deer need time to adapt to the climate change on the Korean Peninsula." He advised that, for now, deer farmers should lower the indoor temperature during the antler growing period by ensuring smooth air circulation in the pens, sprinkling water on the floors, and providing cool drinking water.

⁵ <http://www.foodtoday.or.kr/news/article.html?no=183713>

⁶ <https://www.foodnews.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=107999>



2024-05-20, Korea Deer Times

2.13 Nationwide pasture area declines again last year

The nationwide **pasture area in South Korea decreased by 230 hectares (0.7%) last year, totalling 31,784 hectares**. Reasons for the decline include development projects (170 hectares) and loss of pasture functions (74 hectares). Jeju Island has the largest pasture area (15,435 hectares, 49% of the total). Pastures are primarily used for grazing (42.2%) and fodder crop cultivation (22.1%). About one-third of the total pasture area is currently unused due to poor maintenance.



2024-05-20, Korea Deer Times

2.14 Locking the door, no strange visitors to the farm.

There is increasing controversy over the cutting and sale of deer velvet and claims of animal abuse. Many deer farms are **concealing the deer velvet cutting process from visitors by installing temporary barriers**. While some visitors are unaware or indifferent, there is concern among animal rights activists and consumers about the treatment of deer. Some farms are avoiding media scrutiny by hiding the cutting process, leading to criticism from the public and animal welfare advocates.



2024-05-20, Korea Deer Times

2.15 SiwonDeer unveils new tech for efficient deer velvet use in Korean medicine

SiwonDeer* (www.siwondeer.com) has advanced extraction and drying technology for using deer velvet effectively in traditional Korean medicine.

SiwonDeer imports high-quality deer velvet from New Zealand and processes them with cutting-edge techniques to preserve their full active ingredients. The resulting **100% pure extract powder** is easy to use and more affordable due to bulk purchasing and direct imports. SiwonDeer aims to provide cost-effective, high-quality animal-based medicinal products to support traditional Korean medicine practices.

* Carol Song's company advertorial on industry News of traditional medicine.



MinJok Medicine News, 2024-06-04⁷

2.16 Tips for selecting high-quality deer antler for medicinal use

Doctor Jung's column about the selection of high-quality deer velvet, a valued medicine. It emphasizes the importance of origin, with New Zealand being a major producer. It highlights the rigorous **quality control** and **certification processes for medicinal-grade deer velvet** in South Korea. It also compares New Zealand and Russian velvet, stressing **transparency and safety in sourcing and processing**. The article advises consumers to consider these factors when choosing deer antler products.

Hyungsoo Jung, Int'l Director of the Gyeonggi-do Association of Korean Medicine (Director of Gwangju Kyunghee Soo Korean Medicine Clinic)



JoonBoo Ilbo, 2024-06-04⁸

2.17 Stop the deer antler industry that exploits deer

On the afternoon of the 11th, members of the **KAAP (Korea Association for Animal Protection)** held a press conference at Gwanghwamun Square in Jongno-gu, Seoul, urging the cessation of the deer velvet industry. They performed a demonstration **calling for an end** to the exploitation of deer for their antlers.

⁷ <https://www.mjmedi.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=58672>

⁸ <https://www.joongboo.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=363655690>



Newsis, 2024-06-11⁹

2.18 PL Korea launches 'SKG Deer Antler Velvet' for Growing Children

**This product has been featured in multiple news articles. However, its details are not visible on the product's [sales webpage](#). The none of consumer comments also suggests that it may not currently be available for purchase.*

PL Korea Trade launched 'SKG Deer Antler Velvet' for children's health. The product contains deer velvet extract and other beneficial ingredients to support growth, immunity, and overall health. It's formulated with a child-friendly sweet taste. The company aims to gain parents' trust and plans to introduce more children's health products in the future.



Vitamin News, 2024-06-12¹⁰

2.19 Fusion of tradition and modernity opens new possibilities for Korean medicine

The Seoul Korean Medicine Association (President Park Seong-woo) will host the '2024 Korean Medicine and Integrative Medicine International Industry Expo (K-MEX)' on June 23 at COEX. This event, the first of its kind since 2011, will showcase the latest trends and prospects in Korean and integrative medicine. It will feature a variety of products, technologies, and services, including **medical devices, pharmaceuticals, and clinical systems**. The expo aims to enhance global competitiveness and provide new business opportunities through expert lectures, discussions, and a business matching program. The association seeks to promote the growth and global recognition of Korean medicine through this event.

⁹ https://www.newsis.com/view/NISI20240611_0020374191

¹⁰ <https://www.vitamin-news1.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=2805>

Kookmin Ilbo, 2024-06-17¹¹

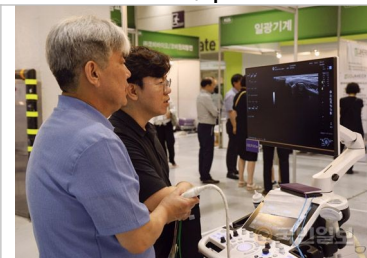
2.20 Kang Seok-joo Encourages industry at 'K-MEX' exhibition

Kang Seok-joo, Chairman of the Health and Welfare Committee of the Seoul Metropolitan Council, attended the '**K-MEX Korean Medicine and Integrative Medicine International Industry Expo**' on June 23. The exhibition, held at COEX in Seoul, aims to enhance the global competitiveness of Korean medicine and integrative medicine. Organized by the Seoul Korean Medicine Association and supported by various health organizations, the event showcases the latest trends in the industry. Kang emphasized the importance of Korean medicine and thanked the organizers for their efforts in promoting its value globally.

E News Today, 2024-06-28¹²

2.21 The Future of Korean Medicine and Integrative Medicine

The Seoul Korean Medicine Association hosted the 'Korean Medicine and Integrative Medicine International Industry Expo' on the 23rd at COEX Hall C in Samseong-dong, Gangnam-gu, Seoul. The expo featured a variety of booths related to Korean and integrative medicine, including medical devices, consumables, pharmaceuticals, clinical systems, and clinic consulting.



Visitors experienced ultrasound diagnostic equipment at the GE Ultrasound booth of the Korean

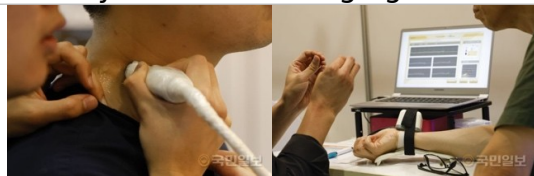


At the FineDMED booth, attendees tried out various medical devices.

¹¹ <https://www.kmib.co.kr/article/view.asp?arcid=0020210301&code=61141111>

¹² <https://www.ewestoday.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=2145692>

Society of Medical Imaging.



Various other medical devices were also showcased and experienced by visitors.



Hanpure staff demonstrated IT-based herbal medicine preparation.

Kookmin Ilbo, 2024-06-23¹³

2.22 Hanpure showcases traditional Korean medicine at K-MEX Expo

Hanpure, a traditional Korean medicine company, participated in the K-MEX International Industry Expo held in Seoul. During the event, they showcased **IT-based herbal medicine preparation systems**, various herbal medicines, and **deer velvet products**. Notably, their booth featured a miniature of Bojewon and an interactive zone for their IT preparation system, attracting significant attention. Hanpure's vision is to enhance the growth of Korean medicine and provide better services in the future.



IT Biz News, 2024-06-28¹⁴

2.23 Korean deer velvet company, Mom-en-yong

Ahn Jong-ho, the CEO of Mom En Young Bio, a company specializing in deer antler products (nokyong) in Cheongju, Chungbuk. Established in 2015, the company operates with the support of the Ministry of Agriculture, Food and Rural Affairs, Chungcheongbuk-do, and Cheongju-si, and has **invested 6.9 billion KRW** in an HACCP-certified processing facility. Ahn also runs the Chungbuk Deer Farm, the largest in South Korea, with over **1,000 elk deer**.

Key points include the strict hygiene and safety measures during antler cutting season in June, and the nutritional and medical care provided to the deer to ensure high-quality nokyong. Ahn highlights the superiority of domestic nokyong, **stored at -55°C and dried within 24 hours using patented methods, compared to foreign nokyong, which risks spoilage during a 45-day drying process.**

¹³ <https://www.kmib.co.kr/article/view.asp?arcid=0020232620&code=61121111>

¹⁴ <https://www.itbiznews.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=138347>

Mom En Young Bio's nokyong is gaining international popularity, being exported to Australia and generating interest in Vietnam. Ahn sees significant potential for nokyong as a high-value industry, similar to the use of salmon sperm in dermatology, and is committed to scientifically validating its benefits to rejuvenate the domestic deer industry.



The Farmers Newspaper, 2024-06-25¹⁵

2.24 KDBA introduces reward system to combat illegal deer velvet imports

The Korea Deer Breeders Association (KDBA) is taking action against illegal imported deer velvet. They've decided to offer a KRW 10 mil (**NZD 12k**) **reward for reporting illegal sales of imported deer (fresh) velvet**. This initiative, restarting after 22 years, aims to protect local deer farmers and maintain industry integrity. The KDBA president urges deer farmers to unite and actively participate in reporting illegal activities to safeguard their livelihoods.



The Korea Deer Times, 2024-06-25

2.25 JungKwanJang to hit Sprouts Farmers Market shelves in US

Korea Ginseng Corporation (KGC) announced a deal with **U.S. supermarket chain Sprouts Farmers Market to distribute its JungKwanJang red ginseng products**. Sprouts operates 415 stores across the U.S., with annual sales of \$6.4 billion. Boosted by successful sales through Costco and Amazon, KGC will now supply three products tailored for U.S. tastes: Everytime 2000mg, **Everytime Powerful Deer Antler**, and Everytime Energy Boost. This contract targets the middle and upper-class market, expanding KGC's presence in the U.S.

¹⁵ <https://www.nongmin.com/article/20240624500840>



The Korea Herald, 2024-06-26¹⁶



News video - <https://youtu.be/0rtqjO9kcKI>

¹⁶ <https://www.koreaherald.com/view.php?ud=20240626050649>

3 News related with product launching

3.1 Dr Lee 'The Himchan Nokyong Double Impact'

Brand <Product name>	DR Lee The Himchan Nokyong < Double Impact >		
Company/Manufacturer	SP Corporation, Dowon Health / Green Bio		
Volume and type	1980ml (66ml x 30 pouches)	Price in KRW	99,000
Product category	Extracted food	Other ingredients	Deer meat 1%
Deer velvet %	0.1% in 92.95% of deer velvet herbal complex extract liquid	Origin of velvet	New Zealand

Lee Kyung-jae, known for his beloved Nokyong products since 2014, launches a new double-impact product combining deer meat with his 10 years of expertise in Nokyong products.

An official from the company emphasized the significance of importing deer meat extract, not previously cleared through customs in Korea, directly from New Zealand for product development.

Deer meat, enjoyed by Queen Elizabeth II and revered in Korean history by King Yeongjo, is renowned for its nutritional value, boasting significantly higher protein and over six times less fat per 100g compared to beef, making it a premium meat widely recognized in Europe and North America.

Lee Kyung-jae, the product developer, noted the increasing lifespan contrasted with decreasing muscle mass among middle-aged and older adults, prompting the development of a product incorporating deer venison to provide further assistance. He expressed joy in completing the long-awaited "**Nokyong Deer Meat Extract**," as the ingredient was not locally available. The product premiered on NS Home Shopping on May 4, 2024, at 10:20 AM.



2024-04-24, News TnT¹⁷

3.2 Instagram Influencer, Mina Lee 'Blessing Lab Plus Tongchihwan'

Brand <Product name>	Blessing Lab Plus < Tongchihwan >		
Company/Manufacturer	Cosmetic The L / Diwali Bio		
Volume and type	135g (4.5g x 30 balls)	Price in KRW	99,000
Product category	Processed foods	Other	Hemp seeds,

¹⁷ <https://www.newstnt.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=365819>

		ingredients	Angelica Gigas Root
Deer velvet %	Not stated	Origin of velvet	New Zealand

Cosmetic The L Co., Ltd. is launching 'Tongchihwan', a new premium herbal supplement under its Blessing Lab Plus brand. The product combines traditional Korean medicine, Gongjindan with modern superfoods like **hemp seeds**. It claims to offer various health benefits including brain function improvement, sleep enhancement, and vascular health support. The company aims to differentiate itself in the high-end supplement market with its unique formulation and **competitive pricing**. The product will be available for purchase starting May 29th at Naver store of Blessing and for more information at Mina Lee's [Instagram](#).



Baby News, 2024-04-26¹⁸

3.3 Cheonho N Care 'Chimhyang Cheonjindan'

Brand <Product name>	Cheon Sim Bon < Chimhyang Cheonjindan >		
Company/Manufacturer	Cheonho N Care		
Volume and type	120g (4g x 30 balls)	Price in KRW	310,000
Product category	Processed foods	Other ingredients	Aloes wood
Deer velvet %	12%	Origin of velvet	New Zealand

Cheonho N Care has launched 'Chimhyang Cheonjindan', a premium health supplement in a small ball format. It contains 15 valuable ingredients, including **23% agarwood and 12% deer velvet**. The product is made without artificial additives, using only acacia honey as a binder. It's marketed as a high-quality health food suitable for adults needing to boost their strength, and is packaged for gift-giving.



News Tap, 2024-06-16¹⁹

Appendix I. Spreadsheets are supplied separately

Import statistics. Korean import	Biosecurity pass recording not HS Code based trade records by export country . Source is Animal and Plant Quarantine
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¹⁸ <https://www.ibabynews.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=116818>

¹⁹ <http://m.newstap.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=219079>

statistics for deer velvet.xlsx	Agency (농림축산검역본부 ²⁰)
Food imports list. Korean food imports list for deer velvet.xlsx	Number of trade recording by food importers and products they imported. No volume or price of each trade but counting trade events. No data for imports for pharmaceutical purpose. Source is Imported Food Information Maru website (수입식품정보마루 ²¹)
Food products. Deer velvet food products in Korea.xlsx	Accumulated food product list over recent years. Based on various news article about product launching mostly supplied originally by the brand owner as a press release activity.

*To access previous reports please access [this online folder](#)

²⁰ <http://eminwon.qia.go.kr/statistics/> (품목-국가별 수출입현황)

²¹ <https://impfood.mfds.go.kr/CFCCC01F01>